

P4M4: The Structure of Dr.Cho's ASE Courses

Characteristics

1. Build Real Applications
2. Integrated Curriculum
3. Theory Emerges from Practice
4. Problem Solving with Proven Methods

1. Build Real Applications

- Each course centers on hands-on projects
- Students develop working software, not just abstract concepts

2. Integrated Curriculum

- Core ideas are revisited across courses
- Learning is deepened through varied perspectives

3. Theory Emerges from Practice

- Principles and patterns are discovered through experience
- Students understand the value of theory through real-world examples

4. Problem Solving with Proven Methods

- Focus on solving problems using time-tested tools, techniques, and SWE principles
- Students become systematic and confident problem solvers

The Four Learning Levels: M4

- **M1: Magic** – At first, everything feels like magic
- **M2: Machine** – As we learn the theory, things become systems we understand
- **M3: Master** – With practice, we gain mastery
- **M4: Make** – By creating, we internalize what we've learned

The Four Activities: P4

- **P1: Principles** – The truths behind the “Machine”
- **P2: Patterns** – Reusable solutions by “Masters”
- **P3: Practices** – The repeated actions that develop mastery
- **P4: Projects** – What we make to truly learn and integrate everything

Understanding Theory vs Practice from P4

- Theories: Principles & Patterns
- Application: Practices & Projects

Theories (P1/P2)

- **Principles** – Timeless truths and rules that guide software design
- **Patterns** – Proven solutions to recurring problems

Theories help us **understand why** things work.

Application (P3/P4)

- **Practices** – Repeated actions that develop skills
- **Projects** – Real-world applications that integrate everything

Practice helps us **know how** to make things work.

Analogy

- **Theories** are like a **map** — they guide us through the terrain
 - **Application** is the **journey** — walking the path, learning by doing
- *You need both the map (theories) and the journey (application) to reach your destination.*
 - *Research shows that starting with the application leads to a deeper understanding of theories.*

P4M4 Model

P4	M4
P4: Project	M4: Make
P3: Practice	M3: Master
P2: Pattern	M2: Machine
P1: Principle	M1: Magic

- We can solve any problem when we **know** the principles and patterns—and **understand** how to apply them to create solutions.

Three Phases of the Course

-  Phase 1 (**Weeks 1–2**)
 - Introduction & Setup
-  Phase 2 (**Weeks 3–10**)
 - Skill Building through Practice
-  Phase 3 (**Weeks 11–16**)
 - Capstone Project

Phase 1 (**Weeks 1–2**): Introduction & Setup

- Set up tools and development environment
- Learn basic concepts and workflows

P3M1 (Practice + Magic)

P4	M4
P4: Project	M4: Make
P3: Practice	M3: Master
P2: Pattern	M2: Machine
P1: Principle	M1: Magic

Phase 2 (**Weeks 3–10**): Skill Building through Practice

- Emphasizes the transformation from early intuition to structured knowledge.
- Highlights preparation for the final project.

P13/M12 (Magic/Machine + Practice/Principle)

P4	M4
P4: Project	M4: Make
P3: Practice	M3: Master
P2: Pattern	M2: Machine
P1: Principle	M1: Magic

Phase 3 (**Weeks 11–16**): Capstone Project

- Apply what you've learned in a full project
- Work individually or in teams

Start week may be adjusted based on class progress

P24/M34 (Master/Make + Pattern/Project)

P4	M4
P4: Project	M4: Make
P3: Practice	M3: Master
P2: Pattern	M2: Machine
P1: Principle	M1: Magic